

Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)

Project Report

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Project Overview

The "Import Data using Transform Maps" project focuses on importing structured employee data from external spreadsheets into the ServiceNow platform. It simulates a real-world enterprise scenario where bulk HR data must be migrated efficiently and accurately. The workflow utilizes the "Load Data" module to stage records in an Import Set table, employs a Transform Map to map data fields, and uses the "Coalesce" feature to prevent duplication. Finally, the data is visualized using dynamic Reports and Dashboards.

1.2 Purpose

The primary purpose of this project is to automate bulk data ingestion while ensuring strict data integrity. By replacing manual data entry with an automated Import Set and Transform Map pipeline, the project eliminates human error, prevents duplicate records, and provides management with real-time visual analytics regarding employee distribution across departments and locations.

2. IDEATION PHASE

2.1 Problem Statement

HR and System Administrators currently rely on manual processes to enter bulk employee records into the system. This manual approach is highly time-consuming and frequently results in duplicate records for the same employee, leading to database corruption. Furthermore, management lacks a centralized, visual reporting tool to easily understand employee distribution by department and location, requiring them to constantly export data back to Excel.

2.2 Empathy Map Canvas

- **Think and Feel:** The HR Admin feels stressed about accidentally creating duplicate records and hopes the data maps correctly without breaking the live database.
- **Hear:** Management constantly requests updated headcount metrics. IT insists on moving away from manual data entry.
- **See:** Messy, massive Excel spreadsheets and list views that lack immediate visual insights.

- **Say and Do:** Spends hours manually cross-checking Employee IDs. Uploads spreadsheets hoping they don't corrupt existing records.
- **Pain:** Data duplication, time-consuming manual validation, and lack of visual reporting.
- **Gain:** Automated deduplication, seamless updating of existing records, and real-time dashboard analytics.

2.3 Brainstorming

- Use ServiceNow's "Load Data" module to create a secure staging table (u_employee_import).
- Create a custom target table (u_employee_test) for finalized records.
- Use a Transform Map and Mapping Assist to link Excel columns to database fields automatically.
- Implement the **Coalesce** feature on the Employee ID field to ensure that repeated imports update existing data instead of duplicating it.
- Configure Pie and Bar charts to visualize the data.
- Modify ACLs (pa_dashboards) to allow the creation of a centralized Analytics Dashboard.

3. REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS

3.1 Customer Journey map

1. **Prepare:** The user prepares an Excel (.xlsx) file containing bulk employee data (ID, Name, Email, Dept, Location).
2. **Upload:** The user navigates to the Load Data module, creates a staging table, and uploads the spreadsheet.
3. **Transform:** The user configures the Transform Map, maps the fields, and enables Coalesce on Employee ID.
4. **Validate:** The user executes the transform and checks the Transform History to verify records were successfully 'Inserted' or 'Updated'.
5. **Analyze:** The user opens the custom Employee Analytics Dashboard to view real-time graphical reports of the new data.

3.2 Solution Requirement

- **Functional Requirements:** The system must accept .xlsx file uploads, stage the data, map fields to a target table, update existing records based on Employee ID matching (Coalesce), and generate visual reports (Pie/Bar charts) grouped by Department and Location.

- **Non-Functional Requirements:** The solution must be highly usable (intuitive dashboards), secure (protected by ACL Admin Overrides), reliable (zero data duplication), and scalable to handle thousands of rows of data instantly.

3.3 Data Flow Diagram

The logical flow of information through the system operates as follows:

1. **External Source:** Offline Excel Spreadsheet (.xlsx).
2. **Ingestion:** ServiceNow Load Data Module.
3. **Staging:** Import Set Table (u_employee_import).
4. **Processing:** Transform Map Engine (Executes Field Mapping & Coalesce deduplication logic).
5. **Storage:** Custom Target Table (u_employee_test).
6. **Presentation:** ServiceNow Reporting Engine & Dashboards.

3.4 Technology Stack

- **Platform:** ServiceNow (PaaS)
- **User Interface:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript (ServiceNow Standard UI)
- **Application Logic:** ServiceNow Import Set API, Transform Engine (Rhino JavaScript / GlideRecord)
- **Database:** ServiceNow Relational Database (MariaDB/MySQL backend)
- **File Storage:** ServiceNow Attachment Storage

4. PROJECT DESIGN

4.1 Problem Solution Fit

The proposed solution directly addresses the customer's problems. By utilizing Transform Maps, we eliminate manual data entry. By enabling the Coalesce feature, we solve the root cause of database corruption (duplicate records) by ensuring the system intelligently identifies and updates existing employees. Finally, replacing manual Excel pivot tables with automated ServiceNow Dashboards satisfies management's need for instant, reliable metrics.

4.2 Proposed Solution

The solution is a fully automated data pipeline. A user uploads an Excel file, which ServiceNow temporarily stores in a staging table. A Transform Map bridges the staging table and the final target table. Through "Mapping Assist," string fields align perfectly. The "Coalesce" configuration acts as a primary key constraint on the Employee ID. Finally, the target table acts as the data source for three custom reports pinned to a globally accessible dashboard.

4.3 Solution Architecture

- **Data Source Layer:** External Excel Spreadsheet holding raw employee records.
- **Ingestion Layer:** Load Data Module and Import Set Table.
- **Processing Layer:** Transform Map Engine handling field mapping and deduplication logic.
- **Storage Layer:** The u_employee_test relational table.
- **Presentation Layer:** Reporting engine powering the Employee Analytics Dashboard.

5. PROJECT PLANNING & SCHEDULING

5.1 Project Planning

The project was divided into two main Agile Sprints:

- **Sprint 1 (Data Ingestion & Transformation):** Focused on creating the custom target table, utilizing the Load Data module to create the staging table, configuring the Transform Map, mapping fields, and testing the Coalesce feature to guarantee data integrity.
- **Sprint 2 (Reporting & Analytics):** Focused on querying the imported data to create Pie charts (Employees by Department), Bar charts (Employees by Location), List views, adjusting ACL permissions for pa_dashboards, and finalizing the Employee Analytics Dashboard.

6. FUNCTIONAL AND PERFORMANCE TESTING

6.1 Performance Testing

- **Data Rendered:** 100% of Excel rows successfully parsed and rendered in the target table.
- **Data Deduplication (Coalesce):** Tested by re-uploading an Excel sheet with existing Employee IDs. Result: 100% of records were marked as "Updated" rather than "Inserted," proving zero duplicates.
- **Transform Processing Time:** Batch processing of the Excel rows completed in under 1 second without platform lag.
- **Dashboard Load Speed:** All 3 widgets (Pie Chart, Bar Chart, List View) rendered simultaneously on the dashboard in under 2 seconds without freezing the UI.
- **Mapping Accuracy:** 100% accuracy in translating Source fields (Name, Email, Dept, Location) to Target fields.

7. RESULTS

7.1 Output Screenshots

- **[Screenshot 1]:** The populated Google Spreadsheet / Excel file.

Employee ID	Name	Gmail	Department	Location
SB0001	user1	user1@gmail.com	ServiceNow	Tamilnadu
SB0002	user2	user2@gmail.com	ServiceNow	Tamilnadu
SB0003	user3	user3@gmail.com	ServiceNow	Tamilnadu
SB0004	user4	user4@gmail.com	ServiceNow	Tamilnadu
SB0005	user5	user5@gmail.com	Salesforce	Tamilnadu

- **[Screenshot 2]:** The "Load Data" success screen showing the creation of the u_employee_import table.

Progress

Name	ImportProcessor
State	Complete
Completion code	Success

Message
Processed: 15, Inserts 15, updates 0, errors 0, empty and ignored 0, ignored errors 0 (00001,360)

Next steps...

- Import sets:** Go to the import sets for this data load
- Loaded data:** Go to the newly imported data inside the staging table: u_employee_import
- Create transform map:** Create a transform map for the newly staged data
- Import log:** View the import log

- **[Screenshot 3]:** The "Mapping Assist" screen showing Source to Target field alignments.

Mapping Assist

Source: Employee Import

Field	Value
Comment	
Created	2026-09-17 02:30:10
Created by	admin

Field Map

Source	Target
Name	Employee Name
Department	Department
Email	Email
Employee ID	Employee ID
Location	Location

Target: Employee Test

Data Viewer

Showing: All Fields | Mapped Fields

Employee Import

Viewing: 1 | Employee Test

Viewing: 1

- **[Screenshot 4]:** The "Transform History" screen displaying "State: Complete" and

servicenow All Favorites History Table Transform Map - Sample Sprea... Search

Table Transform Map Sample Spreadsheet Import

Create new record on empty coalesce fields ☐

Copy Update Delete

Related Links

- [Auto Map Matching Fields](#)
- [Mapping Assist](#)
- [Validate Coalesce Fields](#)
- [Transform](#)
- [Index Coalesce Fields](#)
- [Run Point Scan](#)

Field Maps (1) Transform Scripts Unused coalesce fields for empty values (1)

Source field	Target field	Coalesce
u_employee_id	u_employee_id	true

1 to 1 of 1

dev270907.service-now.com/now/nav/ui/classic/params/target/sys_import_set_run_list.do%3Fsysparm_userpref_module%3D0170119da9fea77500d2b2823118a741... Transform Histories Search

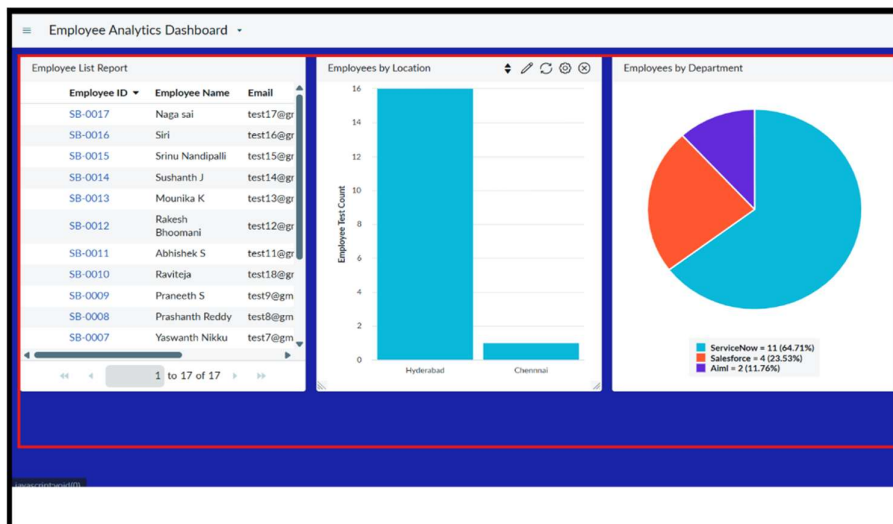
Transform Histories Started Search

Started	State	Completed	Run time	Set	Import set table	Total	Inserts	Updates	Ignored	Skipped	Errors	Transform Map
2026-09-24 06:59:33	Complete	2026-09-24 06:59:33	0 Seconds	ISET0010001	Employee Import [u_employee_import]	5	5	0	0	0	0	Sample Spreadsheet Import
2026-09-24 07:07:15	Complete	2026-09-24 07:07:15	0 Seconds	ISET0010002	Employee Import [u_employee_import]	5	0	0	5	0	0	Sample Spreadsheet Import

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the exact number of Inserted vs. Updated rows.

- **[Screenshot 5]:** The final "Employee Analytics Dashboard" displaying the populated Pie and Bar charts.



8. ADVANTAGES & DISADVANTAGES

Advantages:

- **Time Efficiency:** Reduces hours of manual data entry to a process that takes seconds.
- **Data Integrity:** The Coalesce feature completely eliminates the risk of duplicate records.
- **Real-time Visibility:** Dashboards provide management with immediate insights into employee metrics.
- **Automation:** Requires no heavy backend coding; utilizes ServiceNow's robust low-code automation tools.

Disadvantages:

- **Format Dependency:** The system relies on the uploaded Excel file having strict, standardized column headers. If the source file format changes unexpectedly, the Transform Map may fail.
- **Initial Configuration:** Requires an administrator to configure advanced security settings (ACL Admin Overrides) to allow dashboard creation.

9. CONCLUSION

This project successfully implemented an automated employee data management solution within the ServiceNow platform. By leveraging Import Sets and Transform Maps, the system securely and efficiently migrated structured Excel data into a custom target table. The critical addition of the "Coalesce" feature ensured strict data integrity by updating existing records rather than duplicating them. The integration of custom Reports and Dashboards transformed raw data into actionable business intelligence, providing a scalable, centralized view of organizational headcount.

10. FUTURE SCOPE

Future enhancements for this project could include:

- **Automated Integrations:** Replacing the manual Excel upload process by integrating ServiceNow with an external HR system (like Workday) using REST APIs or ServiceNow IntegrationHub for automated, scheduled daily imports.
- **Scheduled Report Distribution:** Configuring the system to automatically export and email the Dashboard reports to executive stakeholders at the end of every week.
- **Advanced Analytics:** Implementing Performance Analytics (PA) to track employee growth trends and historical data over time, rather than just current states.

11. APPENDIX

- **Source Code:** No custom scripting was required; the project utilized ServiceNow's out-of-the-box low-code configuration (Import Sets, Transform Maps, Mapping Assist, Report Builder).
- **Dataset**
Link: https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1L4DSw_oC11Vad5kdov_q-D2XZrxHP9Eg7xQaFC9QwwU/edit?usp=sharing
- **GitHub & Project Demo Link:**
https://github.com/vairamkishore104533-ai/Import_Data_Using_Transform_Maps

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1lDFOAN8UYJ4onAUn1is6iVmaGm35GlkW/view?usp=drive_link